

Vocabulary list - section one

1. abate – to become less intense or widespread; to reduce something
2. aberration – a departure from what is normal or expected
3. abhor – to regard with disgust and hatred
4. abstain – to choose not to do or take something
5. accolade – an award, or an expression of praise
6. acumen – sharp judgment and quick insight
7. adamant – refusing to be persuaded; unshakably firm
8. admonish – to warn or reprimand gently but firmly
9. adversity – a difficult or unpleasant situation
10. aesthetic – concerned with beauty, or with the appreciation of beauty
11. affable – friendly and easy to talk to
12. alleviate – to make pain or a problem less severe
13. aloof – distant and uninvolved; emotionally cool
14. altruism – unselfish concern for the welfare of others
15. ambiguous – open to more than one interpretation; unclear
16. ambivalent – having mixed or contradictory feelings about something
17. anachronism – something placed in the wrong historical period
18. analogous – comparable in some useful respect
19. anecdote – a short personal story used to illustrate a point
20. animosity – strong hostility or ill will
21. anomaly – something that deviates from the standard or expected
22. antipathy – a deep-seated dislike
23. apathy – lack of interest, enthusiasm, or concern
24. appease – to pacify someone by giving in to their demands
25. arbitrary – based on personal whim rather than reason or rule
26. arcane – understood by very few; mysteriously obscure
27. arduous – requiring great effort; strenuous
28. articulate – able to express thoughts clearly and fluently
29. ascetic – a person who practices severe self-discipline and abstinence
30. assiduous – showing great care and persistent effort
31. astute – shrewd; quick to see an advantage
32. audacious – boldly daring, sometimes to the point of recklessness

- 33. augment – to make greater by adding to it
- 34. auspicious – suggesting a favorable outcome; promising